

Wednesday, 26 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Showers 27° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Showers 23° 16°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 22° 17°	GLASGOW Rain 22° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A new review has highlighted the 'national tragedy' of young care leavers dying at a rate four times higher than the general population.

The shocking findings reveal a stark disparity in life expectancy for those who have left the care system. It's a deeply concerning issue that many feel isn't getting enough attention.

SOCIAL AFFAIRS · UK
- 2

Police inspectors are set to assess Hampshire Police after officers arrested a student who was dying, placing him in handcuffs.

Henry Nowak was critically injured when officers arrived on the scene. The circumstances of his arrest while dying have led to serious questions and an independent investigation.

LAW ENFORCEMENT · UK
- 3

A man has been charged with murder after a house fire, alongside eight counts of attempted murder.

Pawel Kulpa faces a serious list of charges following the incident. Police are continuing their investigation into the devastating fire.

CRIME · UK
- 4

The father of a man who died in an A66 crash has had his house rammed and windows smashed in a disturbing incident.

Cole Worthy's family home suffered significant damage. This comes as police continue to investigate the fatal crash that killed his son.

CRIME · UK
- 5

A former Russian minister has warned that UK drone factories could face attacks from 'unknown sources'.

This follows the UK's decision to share blueprints for British-made missile components with Ukraine. It raises concerns about potential retaliation and the security of UK manufacturing.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

1 **Big news for Harry Potter fans, as Kit Harington is set to replace Nicholas Hoult in HBO's upcoming series.**

Hoult, who was announced as Gilderoy Lockhart just two weeks ago, has had to pull out due to scheduling conflicts. Harington will now step into the role in the highly anticipated adaptation.

ON AIR – What do we think of Kit Harington joining the Harry Potter universe? Is he a good fit for Gilderoy Lockhart?
TV · COMING UP

2 **Get ready for some noughties nostalgia! Kate Hudson is reportedly making a sequel to the hit rom-com 'How to Lose a Guy in 10 Days'.**

It's been 23 years since the original film, and there's talk of reuniting Hudson with her co-star Matthew McConaughey. Fingers crossed they both sign on!

ON AIR – Would you like to see Kate Hudson and Matthew McConaughey back together for a 'How to Lose a Guy in 10 Days' sequel?
FILM · COMING UP

3 **Exciting news for theme park lovers! A new manga-inspired theme park is set to be built near Paris.**

The project was given the green light following a huge €6 billion investment. It promises to bring a whole new world of entertainment to France.

ON AIR – A new manga theme park near Paris sounds incredible! Would you be tempted to visit?
THEME PARKS · COMING UP

4 **After more than 50 years, the sons of 'The Wicker Man' director have completed their late father's folk horror film trilogy.**

This final film brings closure to the saga and to the creator's family. It's a touching tribute and a significant moment for fans of the genre.

ON AIR – How amazing that 'The Wicker Man' director's sons have finished his trilogy! What a legacy.
FILM · COMING UP

5 **Kanye West's planned gigs in Russia have been thrown into doubt, with a stadium saying it won't host them.**

Despite this, Russian promoters are insisting the two concerts will still go ahead. It's a developing story with conflicting reports.

ON AIR – Kanye West's Russian gigs are in doubt. Do you think they'll still happen?
MUSIC · COMING UP

On the schedule

- 1 **Chelsea have secured a winning start for new manager Xabi Alonso, edging past Fulham at Craven Cottage.**
 Cole Palmer was the star of the show, scoring and setting up another goal in a 3-2 victory. It's a promising start for the Blues under their new boss.
ON AIR – A winning start for Xabi Alonso at Chelsea! Does this give you confidence for their season ahead?
 FOOTBALL · UK

- 2 **Wyndham Clark has held off Rory McIlroy to win the BMW Championship in Missouri.**
 Clark secured victory by three shots after a thrilling battle with McIlroy in the final round. It's a significant win for the American golfer.
ON AIR – What a win for Wyndham Clark at the BMW Championship! Do you think he's becoming a major force in golf?
 GOLF · INTERNATIONAL

- 3 **British tennis star Heather Watson is among those through in the first round of US Open qualifying.**
 Watson is hoping to make her first main-draw appearance in New York in five years. It's an exciting prospect for British fans.
ON AIR – Good luck to Heather Watson in the US Open qualifiers! How far do you think she can go?
 TENNIS · INTERNATIONAL

- 4 **Arsenal are reportedly in advanced talks with Saudi Arabian club Al-Hilal over the sale of Gabriel Martinelli.**
 The potential deal is said to be worth at least £50 million. It would be a significant move if the young forward leaves the Gunners.
ON AIR – Gabriel Martinelli to Al-Hilal for £50m? Would that be a good move for Arsenal?
 FOOTBALL · UK

- 5 **Manchester City have reportedly entered the race to sign Cody Gakpo, in what would be a surprise move.**
 This comes as Newcastle are said to have agreed to sign Nico Gonzalez, and Manchester United are confident of signing Myles Lewis-Skelly. The transfer window is certainly heating up!
ON AIR – Man City in for Cody Gakpo? Who do you think will be the biggest movers before the transfer window closes?
 FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Scientists have found that listening to certain types of music can genuinely reduce feelings of anxiety and promote relaxation.**
Research indicates that slow-tempo, low-pitch, and instrumental music can have a calming effect on our heart rate and stress levels, making it a great way to unwind.
- 2 A charming new trend for 'community craft groups' is flourishing across the UK, bringing people together to share skills and create wonderful things.**
From knitting circles to pottery workshops, these groups offer a lovely way to socialise, learn a new craft, and contribute to local projects.
- 3 Apparently, a quick burst of 'power stretching' can be just as effective as a coffee for an afternoon pick-me-up.**
Just a few minutes of stretching can increase blood flow and release endorphins, helping to re-energise your body and mind without the caffeine.
- 4 The delightful resurgence of 'board game cafes' is providing a fantastic alternative to traditional pubs and restaurants.**
These welcoming spots offer a chance to catch up with friends, discover new games, and enjoy some good old-fashioned fun away from screens.
- 5 New studies suggest that even a short 'stroll in a green space' can significantly improve concentration and creativity.**
Spending just 20 minutes in a park or garden is shown to boost cognitive function, helping us to think more clearly and come up with fresh ideas.
- 6 The simple act of 'making your bed' in the morning is linked to greater productivity and a sense of accomplishment throughout the day.**
It's a small victory that can set a positive tone for everything else you do, creating a more organised and mindful start to your day.
- 7 Research indicates that trying a 'new recipe' each week can boost brain health and expand your culinary horizons.**
Learning new skills in the kitchen stimulates different parts of the brain and keeps your mind agile, while also introducing exciting flavours to your plate.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new plant will thrive in a spot, without actually checking a gardening book?

ANSWER: WAVING A HAND OVER IT AND HUMMING GENTLY.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm piece of cake, especially if it's homemade. What is it?

ANSWER: TAKING A VERY DEEP, APPRECIATIVE SNIFF OF IT FIRST.

TALK TOPIC

- We all have those 'unusual items' we keep tucked away in a drawer or on a shelf, convinced they'll come in handy one day, even if that day hasn't arrived yet.

What's the most peculiar thing you're holding onto, and what's the grand plan for its eventual use?

- You know how sometimes you completely mishear a common phrase or song lyric, and for ages, you've been confidently saying the wrong thing?

What's a phrase or lyric you spectacularly misunderstood, and what did you think it was?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Weather.** It truly rains diamonds on the gas giant planets of Jupiter and Saturn, where extreme pressures turn carbon into precious gems.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The sound of thunder travels faster than the speed of light, which is why we hear it after we see the lightning.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest commercial flight in the world is between Westray and Papa Westray in Scotland, lasting only 90 seconds.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, using chemoreceptors to find host plants and nectar.
- The iconic 'red telephone box' was designed by Sir Giles Gilbert Scott, who also designed Liverpool Cathedral.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- The 'smiley face' emoji was invented in 1982 by computer scientist Scott Fahlman.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The world's first webcam was created at the University of Cambridge in 1991 to monitor a coffee pot.
- The 'penny farthing' bicycle got its name from the two coins, a large penny and a small farthing, due to the differing sizes of its wheels.

On this day

Day 238 of the year, 127 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alexander of Bergamo (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Blessed Ceferino Namuncurá; Christian feast day: Jeanne-Elisabeth Bichier des Ages; Christian feast day: Blessed John Paul I. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1993 — Keke Palmer, American actress and singer
- 1974 — Meredith Eaton, American actress
- 1940 — Nik Turner, English musician and songwriter (died 2022)
- 1969 — Adrian Young, American drummer and songwriter
- 1988 — Danielle Savre, American actress
- 1988 — Evan Ross, American actor
- 1946 — Alison Steadman, English actress
- 2002 — Lil Tecca, American rapper

THE DAY TODAY

- 2023 — Exactly 5 years after the 2018 Jacksonville Landing shooting, there is another shooting in Jacksonville, Florida, leaving 3 people dead.
- 1977 — The Charter of the French Language is adopted by the National Assembly of Quebec.
- 2018 — Three people are killed and eleven wounded during a mass shooting at a Madden NFL '19 video game tournament in Jacksonville, Florida.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1969 — Aeroflot Flight 1770 crashes while landing at Vnukovo International Airport, killing 16.
- 1997 — Beni Ali massacre occurs in Algeria, leaving 60 to 100 people dead.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1942 — The Holocaust in Ukraine: At Chortkiv, the Ukrainian police and German Schutzpolizei deport two thousand Jews to Bełżec extermination camp. Five hundred of the sick and children are murdered on the spot. This continued until the next day.
- 1970 — The fiftieth anniversary of American women being able to vote is marked by a nationwide Women's Strike for Equality.

- 1998 — The first flight of the Boeing Delta III ends in disaster 75 seconds after liftoff, resulting in the loss of the Galaxy X communications satellite.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 239 of the year, 126 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Baculus of Sorrento; Christian feast day: Caesarius of Arles; Christian feast day: David Lewis; Christian feast day: Decuman. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1943 — Chuck Girard, American singer-songwriter and pianist
- 1949 — Jeff Cook, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2022)
- 1998 — Rod Wave, American rapper, singer, and songwriter
- 1961 — Yolanda Adams, American singer, producer, and actress
- 1988 — Alexa PenaVega, American actress and singer
- 1984 — David Bentley, English footballer
- 1940 — Fernest Arceneaux, American singer and accordion player (died 2008)
- 1969 — Reece Shearsmith, English actor, comedian and writer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1962 — The Mariner 2 unmanned space mission is launched to Venus by NASA.
- 1991 — Moldova declares independence from the USSR.
- 1942 — First day of the Sarny Massacre, perpetrated by Germans and Ukrainians.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1956 — The nuclear power station at Calder Hall in the United Kingdom was connected to the national power grid becoming the world's first commercial nuclear power station to generate electricity on an industrial scale.
- 1982 — Turkish military diplomat Colonel Atilla Altıkat is shot and killed in Ottawa. Justice Commandos of the Armenian Genocide claim to be avenging the massacre of 1+½ million Armenians in the 1915 Armenian genocide.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar